Marta Kowal-Brandt
DevOps / Platform Engineering | QA Automation & Test Infrastructure

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY
QA automation engineer with experience owning GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral environments for three teams at Odrava Health Software. Built Kubernetes-based merge-request environments and improved CI pipelines, reducing average runtime from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%. Brings hands-on experience with Helm, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI, and observability, alongside personal k3s/GitOps and Terraform projects. Currently transitioning toward DevOps and platform engineering.

SKILLS
CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, pipeline optimization, automated regression and end-to-end testing
Containers and orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm charts for test environments), Helm, k3s, Argo CD
Infrastructure and automation: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Ansible (basic), Bash
Observability and data: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
Programming and testing: Python, Java, pytest, pytest-xdist, Selenium, GitLab API
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics (personal free-tier use)

EXPERIENCE
QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software | 2021 to Present
- Own GitLab CI pipelines and ephemeral environments for three teams.
- Built merge-request environments with an application, PostgreSQL, and seeded data, deployed via Helm to a shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI; environments are removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelized test jobs, added dependency caching, and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage; reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built a flaky-test dashboard using CI results, PostgreSQL, Python, Grafana, and the GitLab API; the flaky-test rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams addressed the leading offenders.
- Wrote the internal guide to how CI works, which is used in onboarding.
- Mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Joined two incident calls as an observer.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House | 2019 to 2021
- Tested web and mobile applications for different clients.
- Introduced the first automated regression suite on the largest project, using Java and Selenium, and configured Jenkins to run it nightly.
- The full regression had previously taken two people three days.

SELECTED PROJECT
Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal | 2024 to 2025
- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana, and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress, and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform.
- Technologies: k3s, Argo CD, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Terraform, Ansible (basic).

CERTIFICATIONS AND DEVELOPMENT
ISTQB Foundation Level, 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA): studying; exam booked for January 2027.
Terraform Associate: completed practice tests; exam not taken.